He used the “plain folks” technique that highlighted his low background and distributed his pictures showing him toil on some humble job. His role as *IL Duce* “the leader” was glorified and heightened.[32]

The United States lacked proper machinery till 1939 either for foreign propaganda or general public information programme. The Office of War Information (OWI), incorporating the “Voice of America” was established during World War II which functioned to support the national policies in the war effort, both at home and abroad. The OWI was abolished later and its functions were transferred to the Department of State. To match the Soviet propaganda post-Second World War, the US Congress enacted foundations of a comprehensive programme of information and cultural relations in tune with the US foreign policy. The purpose of such programme was defined as “to promote mutual understanding between the people of the United States and other countries and also to try to correct the misunderstandings about America”. In 1953, the then US President Eisenhower, by a reorganization plan, established the United States Information Agency (USIA) as a separate executive branch. Since its creation the USIA has played a major role in official propaganda abroad. The well-known branch of USIS, USIA is the “Voice of America”.

During the Cold War days, both the superpowers utilized their propaganda machineries against each other in order to maintain their spheres of influence. USA often identified the Soviet Union as an “evil empire”. Post-Cold War, after the dissolution of the Soviet Union, it identified as the “axis of evil” (a term used by president George Bush) Libya, Iraq, Iran and North Korea. Again, after the 9/11 terrorist attacks in its “War on Terror”, it identified Saddam Hussain as an abettor of Osama bin Laden and Iraq as a potential threat to humanity being the possessor of weapons of mass destruction (WMDs). In all these cases, though the periods may be different, yet the Americans used their propaganda machinery consisting of press, media, television, Internet blogs, and websites to carry out massive propaganda campaigns against them. At the same time, it also utilized the same to project a favourable image of itself in the international arena.